

SIGNATURE OPERATING BRIEF

Field-to-Platform Buildline

A practical contract for converting a vague client AI mandate into a working workflow with explicit human authority, evidence, recovery, and platform return.

Five Layers

Outcome	What business result must exist, for whom, by when?	Owner, baseline, target behavior
Work	What do operators actually do, including exceptions?	Sequence, handoffs, data, incentives
Authority	What may the system take, suggest, route, or never do?	Permissions, checkpoints, escalation
Evidence	How will behavior, compliance, and value be evaluated?	Test set, measures, acceptance criteria
Recovery	What happens when model, tool, data, or organization is wrong?	Fallback, rollback, incident owner

Build Decision

Workflow first	Rules and orchestration are safer than an agent.	Stable sequence, deterministic controls, clear owner.
Agent assist	Judgment helps but human authority stays central.	Evaluation, context, review, escalation.
Bounded agent	Tools and decisions can be delegated within a narrow envelope.	Permissions, monitoring, audit, fallback.
Do not build	Value, data, authority, or recovery is not credible.	Explicit reason and next information needed.

Engagement Review Record

Mandate	Outcome, owner, baseline, target behavior
Operating truth	Workflow, exceptions, data, incentives, authority
Build choice	Agent/workflow/rules decision and bounded architecture
Control	Permissions, checkpoints, escalation, stop conditions
Proof	Evaluation set, operating measures, acceptance criteria
Recovery	Fallback, rollback, incident owner, learning loop
Platform return	Reusable primitive, context schema, controls, playbook

Scenario: Collections

Likely posture: agent assist with named human authority and regulated communication controls. **Proof:** resolution quality, exceptions, compliance, operator acceptance, and recovery. **Return:** reusable decision pattern and evaluation suite.

The engagement is the research lab - but the operation is the proof.

Platform leverage is earned by owning the field result, not by extracting context without consequence.